

Continue



Anthropic prompt engineering guide

You can now generate production-ready prompt templates in the Anthropic Console using prompt engineering techniques. Describe what you want to achieve, and Claude will create an effective prompt. This feature helps new users and saves time for experienced engineers. Provide detailed information about your task for best results. Although generated prompts may not always produce perfect results, they often outperform hand-written prompts. The templates are editable, allowing you to tweak them for optimal performance. Prompting best practices include role setting and chain of thought reasoning. Role setting involves Claude taking on the characteristics of an expert at the chosen task, while chain of thought reasoning allows for more thorough responses. When generating prompts, variables are often placed between XML tags to clearly delineate different parts of the prompt. For example, when translating code to Python, the longer and more ambiguous `{{CODE}}` variable is marked by XML tags, while the simple `{{LANGUAGE}}` variable is positioned inline. Claude may also write example inputs and outputs to give itself clear direction around the types of answers it thinks you want. You can edit these examples to match your desired output formatting. When using templates generated by the prompt generator, you'll encounter Handlebars notation. For example, to review and classify a chat transcript, you might use: `{{TRANSCRIPT}}` . This process allows you to see how Claude responds across various situations. ZoomInfo uses Claude for making actionable recommendations and driving value for their customers. Their use of prompt generation significantly reduced the time it took to build an MVP of their RAG application, while also improving output quality. Anthropic's new prompt generator feature enabled them to reach production-ready outputs much faster, reducing the time spent tuning their app by 80%. To get started with building production-ready prompts using Claude, visit the Anthropic API. This course aims to provide a comprehensive understanding of how to engineer optimal prompts within Claude. After completing this course, you'll be able to: Master the basic structure of a good prompt Recognize common failure modes and learn techniques to address them Understand Claude's strengths and weaknesses Build strong prompts from scratch for common use cases This course is structured into 9 chapters with accompanying exercises, allowing you many chances to practice writing and troubleshooting prompts yourself. Each lesson includes an "Example Playground" area where you can experiment with the examples in the lesson and see how changing prompts affects Claude's responses. There is also an answer key. Note: This tutorial uses our smallest model, Claude 3 Haiku. Anthropic has two other models, which are more intelligent than Haiku, with Opus being the most intelligent. Letting Claude think through complex tasks like research, analysis, or problem-solving with the "chain of thought" (CoT) prompting technique can significantly improve its performance. This method encourages Claude to break down problems step-by-step, leading to more accurate and nuanced outputs. There are different ways to prompt for thinking, ordered from least to most complex. Basic prompts include a simple instruction like "Think step-by-step," which lacks guidance on how to think. Guided prompts outline specific steps for Claude to follow in its thinking process, while structured prompts use XML tags to separate reasoning from the final answer. To get the best out of CoT, it's essential to understand your success criteria and have a clear definition of what you want to achieve. You should also be able to empirically test against those criteria and have a first draft prompt that needs improvement. This guide focuses on success criteria that can be controlled through prompt engineering. It suggests trying different techniques in order, starting with the most broadly effective methods.

Prompt engineering guide. Anthropic prompt engineering. Prompt engineer anthropic.